Suggested Tech for Your Online Presentations

From Jonathan Foust

There are many options for upgrading your online presentations. I have done a lot of experimenting over the years and below I am listing what I have found works well for me.

Geeks, audiophiles, and videophiles will argue the fine points of these recommendations and indeed there are probably better options out there, but I have found the following to be both easy to set up and dependable.

The Downside of Using a Phone or Tablet

While an iPhone, iPad, or other device will work fine for an online presentation, the built-in cameras and sound could be better. You will also find managing groups more challenging with these devices.

If you are working with a personal computer, here are a few suggestions.

A Good Microphone

Viewers are quick to forgive funky video, but not funky audio. If your sound is off or difficult to listen to, listeners will quickly tune you out.

A microphone can make a huge difference in your effectiveness as a teacher. As you are guiding people into delicate inner states of heightened awareness, when your voice is as pleasing as possible you can be dramatically more effective.

There are many microphones out there. Here's what I use:

The **Blue Yeti** is one of the most popular and easy-to-use microphones out there. It comes with a stand you place on your desk. I have attached mine on a boom, which allows me to swing it out of the way and avoid any inadvertent desk noises when presenting and recording.
Blue Yeti: LINK

Blue Yeti Pop Filter. A pop filter removes the aspirated *b*'s and *p*'s. Most any pop filter will work, but this one integrates well with the Blue Yeti.
Pop Filter – Moukey Microphone Pop Filter: LINK

Boom – NEEWER Adjustable Microphone Suspension Boom Scissor Arm Stand: LINK

Shock Mount (helpful but not critical) – **Blue Radius III Custom Shock Mount**: LINK

A Good Webcam

A good webcam for your computer will probably provide a dramatic upgrade in image quality over your built-in camera. You will also be able to control and tweak your image.

I have had great luck with Logitech webcams.

Logitech: LINK

A Good Webcam Settings App

With a webcam settings app, you will be able to zoom, pan and tilt, and change the saturation levels and warmth. Ultimately, you will be able to create the settings where you will absolutely look your best.

Webcam Settings (macOS): LINK

Webcam Settings (Windows): LINK

Logitech Capture Software Download (Windows and macOS): LINK

Good Lighting

You will find tons of tutorials online that can help you enhance how you look.

The simplest is to face a window and use a shade if the sun is too intense, but you may find it worth the investment to get some lights.

Three-Point Lighting

Three-point lighting places one light to your left, one to your right, and a light behind you to add depth to your image.

I have had great success with Lume Cube panels. I opted for the Lume Cube Panel Go. You will also want some kind of stands for your lights. You can find some on the Lume Cube website. I have also found the following to be pretty cheap and effective:

Gooseneck Stand for Portable Lights: LINK

Lume Cube: LINK

Panel Go: LINK

Lume Cube Panel Mini (a smaller version): LINK

Ring Lighting

A ring light is a circular light that casts an even spread. Some find it to be simple and effective while others find the reflection of the circle on glasses or eyes distracting.

Here are a few you might check out:

Lume Cube Ring Light: LINK

Ring Lights on Amazon: LINK